

Introduction — *The Art of Through*

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.” — Psalm 23:1 (KJV)

Ever feel like your life is on a permanent loading screen—like you’re stuck in the lobby while everybody else is leveling up? That’s what a **“through” season** can feel like: you’re trying, you’re praying, you’re doing the right things... but the situation still isn’t moving.

This month is about learning **the art of “through.”** Not how to dodge hard seasons, but how to **walk with God in them**—with faith, patience, and courage—until you come out stronger.

This month, we’ll learn from four “through” stories:

- **Joseph** — went from pit to prison to purpose, and didn’t lose his character.
- **Hannah** — carried deep pain, but turned it into bold prayer and kept showing up.
- **Abram** — trusted God’s promise when the timeline didn’t make sense.
- **Chronic Conditions** — pushed through obstacles for one touch from Jesus.

Psalm 23 doesn’t say you’ll never face valleys. It reminds you that the Shepherd is close—so even when you’re going through, you don’t have to go through it alone.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY

Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph

The Young Dreamer

 **Theme:** From pit to purpose

 **Background Text:** Genesis 37; 39; 41–42

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 42:6 (WEB)

“Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.”

Appetizer – The Dream That Started It, All Genesis 37:5–8 (WEB)

“⁵Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, ‘Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf.’

⁸His brothers said to him, ‘Will you indeed reign over us? Or will you indeed have dominion over us?’ They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words.”

Sometimes when God gives you a big vision, people closest to you might be the first to try and tear it down. The dream was real, but the reaction was rough.

Reflection Question:

Have you ever shared something you were excited about and felt shut down or hated for it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Betrayed but Not Forgotten, Genesis 37:18–20, 28 (WEB)

¹⁸ They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him.

¹⁹ They said to one another, ‘Behold, this dreamer comes. ²⁰ Come now therefore, and let’s kill him, and cast him into one of the pits...’

²⁸ Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. They brought Joseph into Egypt.

Joseph’s own brothers threw him in a pit and sold him. The betrayal by his own blood cut deeper than the dry pit he sat in. Even as he was being hauled off as a slave, God was tracking his location. The “dreamer” was being positioned, even through rejection.

Reflection Question:

What’s one “pit moment” in your life—where you felt dropped, betrayed, or abandoned?

Bite 2 – Integrity in the Dark, Genesis 39:7–8,10 (WEB)

⁷ After these things, his master’s wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, ‘Lie with me.’ ⁸ But he refused, and said... ‘How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?’ ¹⁰ As she spoke to Joseph day by day, he didn’t listen to her...”

Joseph chose purity even when nobody was watching. Doing the right thing led him to prison because of a lie. Joseph teaches us that integrity isn’t about getting a quick reward; it’s about keeping your character clean so God can trust you with a bigger stage later.

Reflection Question:

Why is it still worth doing the right thing even when it brings temporary pain instead of a quick reward?

Bite 3 – From Prison to Palace, Genesis 41:14, 16, 38 (WEB)

¹⁴ Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon... ¹⁶ Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, ‘It isn’t in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.’ ³⁸ Pharaoh said to his servants, ‘Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?’”

In one day, God pulled Joseph from the dungeon to the throne room. Joseph walked out ready to serve and gave God all the credit. The years of "through" had prepared his heart to handle the weight of the crown without losing his soul.

Reflection Question:

If God opened a huge door for you tomorrow, what kind of character would you need to be ready for it?

Dessert

Joseph’s story shows:

1. The dream was real, even when reality looked like a nightmare.
2. The process was hard, but it was the only way to the throne.
3. God never stopped working, even in the silence of the dungeon.

Reflection Question:

Right now, does your life feel more like the pit, the prison, or the palace? Why?

To-Go Box

- People can betray you, but God doesn’t drop His plans for you.
- Integrity in secret prepares you for influence in public.
- God can use every step to move you toward purpose.

Write one sentence: “God, please use my process to prepare me for my purpose.”

⁷I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...

Years later, God changed Abram's name to Abraham ("Father of many"). God was calling him what he *would* be before he *saw* it. Your identity is fixed by God's promise, not your current progress.

Reflection Question:

How does it help to remember what God calls you when your situation doesn't look like it?

Dessert

Abraham's story says:

1. Real faith is honest enough to ask hard questions.
2. Real faith can still stumble, but God picks it back up.
3. God's timing is perfect, even when it feels "late."

Reflection Question:

What is there an area where you need to stop forcing outcomes and start trusting God again?

To-Go Box

- God isn't scared of your honest questions.
- Shortcuts can complicate your life even when God still loves you.
- God's promises stand, even when your patience doesn't.

Write one sentence: "God, help me trust You with _____."

Word Study

- **Abram** – “Exalted Father”
- **Abraham** – “Father of Many Nations”

El Shaddai – “God Almighty,” the all-sufficient One who sustains, provides, and fulfills His promises.

Prayer

“God Almighty, forgive me for the times I’ve tried to rush Your plan. Help me to walk before You with a trusting heart. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write about one area where you want to slow down and trust God’s timing:

Activity – “True or False”

1. Abraham never questioned God. (T / F)
2. Sarai suggested using Hagar. (T / F)
3. God changed Abram’s name. (T / F)

Notes & Group Discussion
